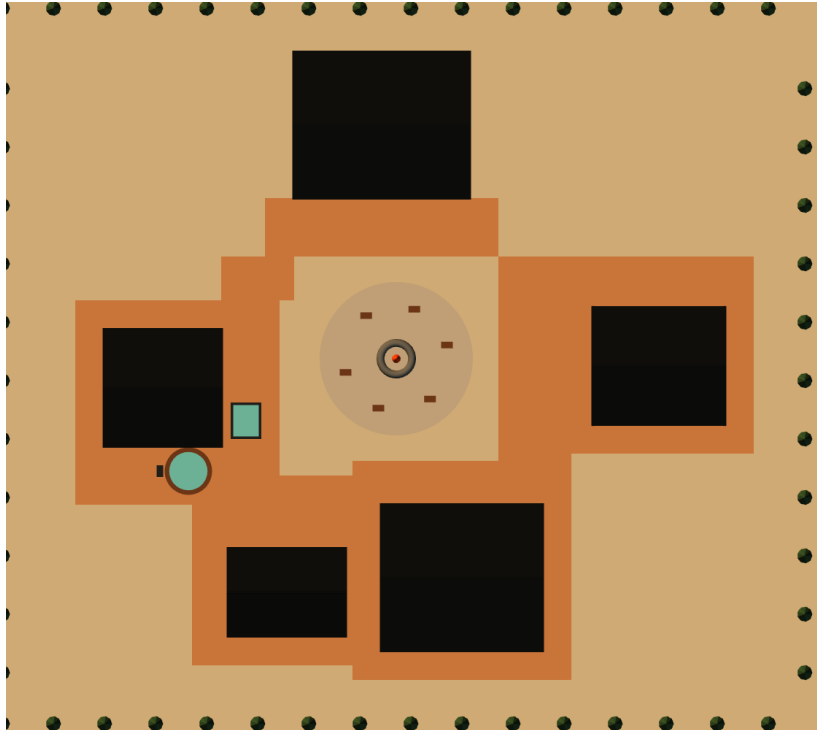


Catskills Micro-Compound

Development Proposal - Revision 3

A staged, deck-linked woodland compound built around a principal tiny home, wellness bathhouse, full ADU, guest sleeping cabin, and outdoor kitchen



Revision 3 master geometry. Each stage pairs the accepted dimension-controlled top-down site plan with a photorealistic exterior visualization grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model.

Design principle

Build a usable retreat immediately, then add amenities and guest capacity over time without moving earlier structures or reworking the basic courtyard geometry.

Conceptual planning document only. Not a survey, construction drawing, zoning determination, septic design, engineering document, or contractor bid.

1. Executive Overview

Goal. Purchase a secluded wooded Catskills parcel and create a compact, low-rise residential compound that can grow incrementally. The finished concept centers a mostly flat firepit courtyard, with structures connected by a deliberately staged deck network.

Master layout. The main tiny home sits at the north edge of the courtyard. The 16 x 16 ft bathhouse sits southwest, the covered outdoor kitchen sits east, and the later residential pieces sit to the south: a ~440 sq. ft. full ADU and a smaller no-kitchen guest sleeping cabin. This relative positioning is locked across every stage illustration in Revision 3.

2. Sample Property Reference

Listing/address	Tbd Rider Hollow Road, Hardenburgh, NY 12406
Listing status when reviewed	Active; \$189,000 asking price. This proposal uses a fixed \$200,000 land allowance.
Acreage / type	Approximately 15.7-16 acres; unimproved wooded land.
Map pin	42.102681, -74.523254
Zillow reference	Rider Hollow Rd / Zillow property ID 32842779
Property qualities relevant to this concept	Wooded and secluded; multiple leveled/excavated areas; driveway; engineered septic; 200+ amp electric availability; seasonal stream; sloped terrain around usable clearings.

Map link: [Google Maps sample-property pin](#) • Listing: [Zillow — Tbd Rider Hollow Road](#)

3. Sample Site Character



Why this listing is a useful characteristic example

The listing describes a 15.7-acre Catskills parcel abutting protected New York State land. It specifically notes that “Multiple areas have been excavated and leveled.” It also reports an existing driveway, installed engineered septic, and electric service ready to connect. The terrain is described as rugged and wooded, with usable clearings, trails, and a seasonal stream. Those are exactly the kinds of attributes that can make a staged compound feasible without paying for every site-development item from scratch.

The concept should nevertheless be budgeted as if a potable well may still be required, because the listing does not establish a conventional approved drinking-water source. Likewise, the septic system’s approved bedroom/design-flow capacity must be obtained before assuming that it can support the final main-home + ADU + guest-cabin occupancy.

Listing photographs and listing-provided map/context images. Source: Zillow / Hudson Valley Catskill Region MLS listing; reproduced here for conceptual property evaluation.

Pre-purchase priority

Obtain the septic approval/as-built, a survey, well feasibility information, utility-service confirmation, and written zoning/building feedback before relying on the parcel for the full master plan.

4. Compound Overview — Final Pieces

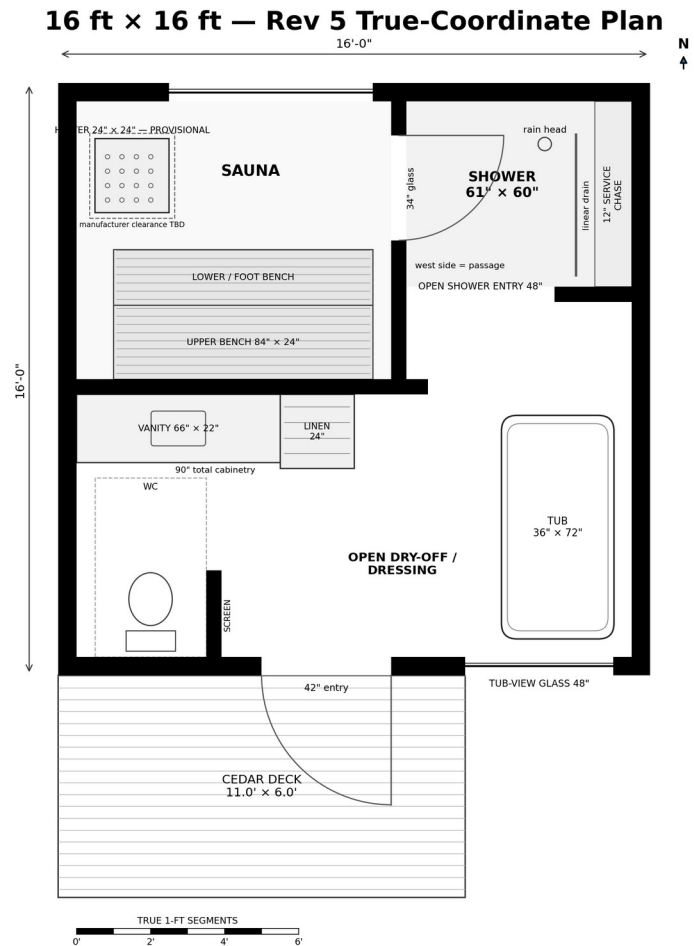
Component	Design intent
Principal tiny home	~24 x 20 ft / 480 sq. ft. Full dwelling with kitchen, bath, sleeping/living space, heat/cooling, and full utilities.
Deck network	Built in increments. Provides circulation and outdoor living while tying the compound together without requiring a major one-time landscape project.
Firepit courtyard	Mostly flat gravel/stone area centered inside the compound. Begins as a simple stone ring; later receives chairs, benches, and low-level lighting.
Bath/sauna house	16 x 16 ft / 256 sq. ft. accessory wellness building. Cedar sauna, shower, soaking tub, vanity/toilet. Courtyard-facing north wall has sauna glass on the observer's right/west side and a solid shower wall on the observer's left/east side.
Wood-fired hot tub + cold plunge	Added after the bathhouse. Hot tub remains outside the bathhouse on its west-side deck; compact cold plunge sits at the shower side of the bathhouse north wall, adjacent to but not obstructing the sauna glass.
Detached ADU	~22 x 20 ft / 440 sq. ft. — intentionally similar in total size to the main tiny home, only slightly smaller. Full kitchen, bath, heat/cooling, electricity, and independent livability.
Guest sleeping cabin	~12 x 16 ft / 192 sq. ft. permitted accessory sleeping building. No kitchen. Preferred “proper” version includes a small full bathroom, electricity, heating/cooling, egress-compliant glazing, and smoke/CO protection.
Outdoor kitchen/bar	Covered open-air pavilion with gas grill, smoker, prep counters, bar counter/stools, lighting, and final deck links. No sleeping use.

Legal/planning framing

The working legal concept is: one principal dwelling; one detached ADU pursued through Hardenburgh’s conditional-use ADU route; one permitted no-kitchen accessory sleeping cabin; and accessory wellness/outdoor-living structures. Ulster County’s current ADU guide identifies Hardenburgh as allowing ADUs by conditional-use permit. The guest cabin should be presented honestly as a sleeping building rather than relying on the ≤144 sq. ft. shed exemption.

Before purchase, seek written confirmation from Hardenburgh that the proposed ADU may use the close compound arrangement and that the no-kitchen guest cabin is acceptable as an accessory sleeping building rather than a third principal dwelling.

5. Bathhouse Basis of Design



Left: 16 x 16 ft Rev 5 true-coordinate bathhouse floor plan. Right: conceptual 3D cutaway illustrating the sauna, shower, vanity/WC zone, soaking tub, glazing, and deck relationship.

Courtyard-facing bathhouse elevation. In the accepted site model the bathhouse is oriented so its east sauna/shower facade faces inward toward the central firepit courtyard. The sauna glazing occupies the northern portion of that courtyard-facing facade, while the southern shower portion remains substantially solid. The bathhouse entry is on the opposite/back side and is reached by the wraparound deck. At Stage 5, the cold plunge sits immediately east of the shower-side portion of the bathhouse; the larger wood-fired hot tub sits south and slightly west of the plunge, overlapping the bathhouse footprint in the east-west dimension.

The sauna heater remains provisional pending actual manufacturer clearance/guard requirements. The floor plan is a concept coordinate plan, not a permit set.

6. Staged Budget Summary — 2026 Planning Dollars

Ranges include a fixed \$200,000 land allowance and show both incremental stage cost and cumulative running cost. Contractor = turnkey/local GC-heavy delivery. Owner DIY = serious owner-builder strategy with substantial self-performed framing, deck, finish carpentry, siding, cabinetry, painting, and selected tile/sauna work, while licensed/specialist trades are still hired where required.

Stage	Scope	Contractor add	Contractor total	Owner DIY add	Owner DIY total
Initial	Land purchase allowance	\$200k	\$200k	\$200k	\$200k
1	Main tiny home — approx. 480 sf	\$165k-\$260k	\$365k-\$460k	\$95k-\$155k	\$295k-\$355k
2	Tiny-home courtyard deck	\$8k-\$14k	\$373k-\$474k	\$4k-\$7k	\$299k-\$362k
3	Flat gravel firepit pad + stone ring	\$4k-\$9k	\$377k-\$483k	\$1.5k-\$4k	\$300.5k-\$366k
4	16 x 16 bathhouse + connecting/wrap deck	\$155k-\$225k	\$532k-\$708k	\$82k-\$125k	\$382.5k-\$491k
5	Firepit seating + cold plunge + wood-fired hot tub	\$20k-\$40k	\$552k-\$748k	\$13k-\$25k	\$395.5k-\$516k
6	Full detached ADU — approx. 440 sf + deck	\$160k-\$250k	\$712k-\$998k	\$90k-\$150k	\$485.5k-\$666k
7	Guest sleeping cabin — full bath/electric/HVAC + deck	\$65k-\$115k	\$777k-\$1.113M	\$35k-\$65k	\$520.5k-\$731k
8	Covered outdoor kitchen/bar + final deck links	\$45k-\$80k	\$822k-\$1.193M	\$25k-\$45k	\$545.5k-\$776k

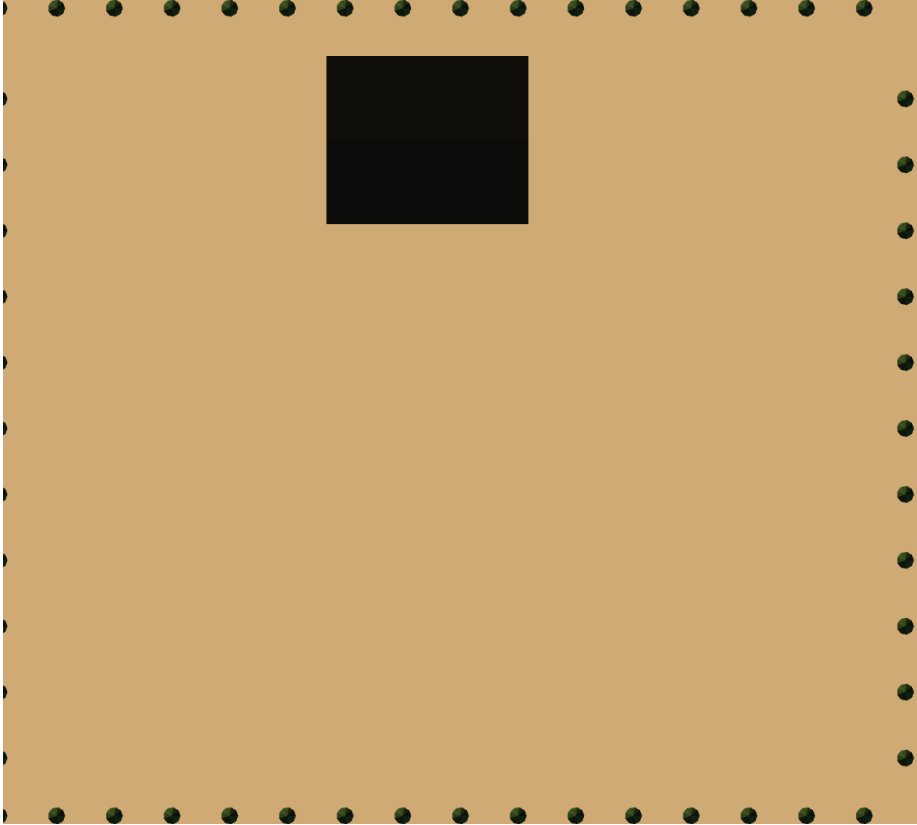
Budget takeaway

Final buildout including the \$200,000 land allowance: approximately \$822k-\$1.193M with contractor-led delivery, or approximately \$545.5k-\$776k with a serious owner-builder approach. Carry an additional well contingency of roughly \$12k-\$35k unless a potable water source is confirmed; septic expansion, difficult retaining work, financing costs, and inflation between stages are not included.

7. Stage 1: Main tiny home

Build the principal dwelling first at approximately 24 x 20 ft / 480 sq. ft. Include kitchen, full bathroom, sleeping/living area, heat pump, full utilities, and an electrical/service strategy sized for later bathhouse and ADU loads.

Contractor: +\$165k-\$260k • cumulative \$365k-\$460k | **Owner DIY:** +\$95k-\$155k • cumulative \$295k-\$355k

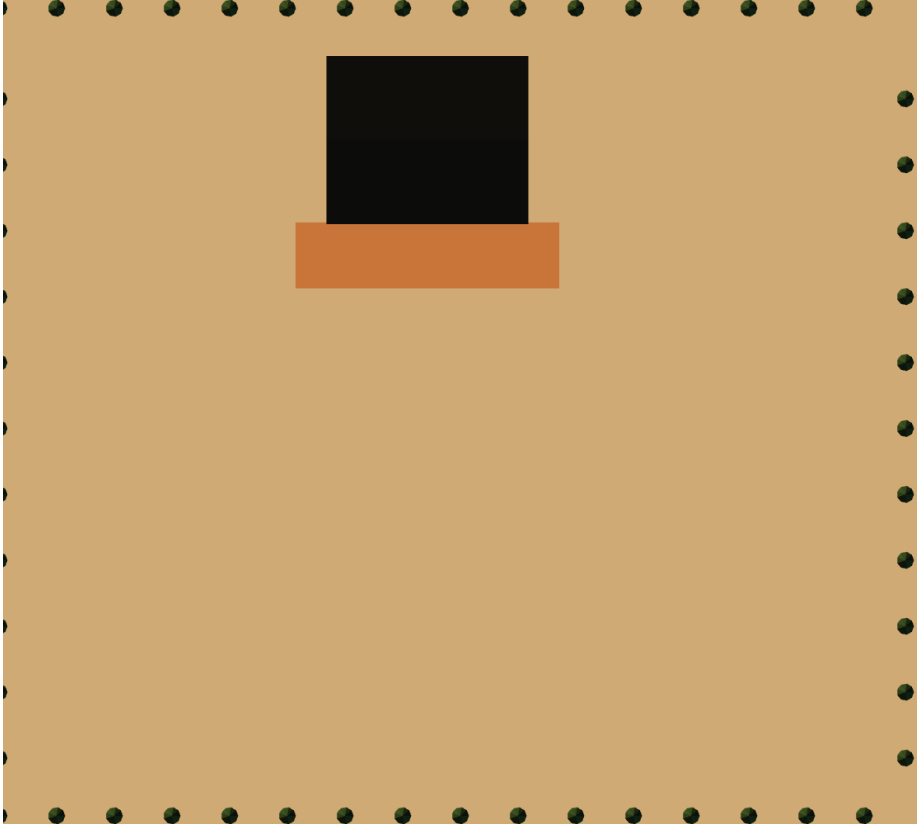


Stage 1: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 2: Courtyard-facing deck

Add the first deck only on the interior/courtyard side of the main home. This establishes the finished outdoor floor datum and future compound geometry without committing to the other buildings yet.

Contractor: +\$8k-\$14k • cumulative \$373k-\$474k | **Owner DIY:** +\$4k-\$7k • cumulative \$299k-\$362k

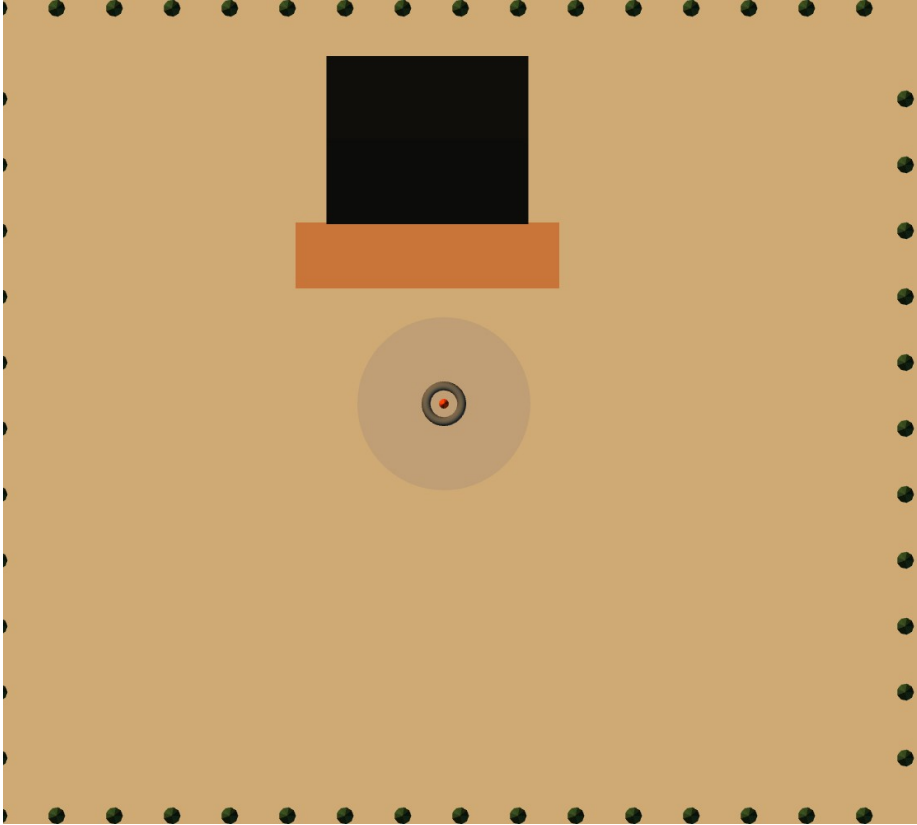


Stage 2: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 3: Simple flat firepit area

Add a mostly flat gravel/crushed-stone firepit circle and masonry/stone fire ring. Avoid sunken landscaping and retaining walls; the intent is simple grading and an easy-to-maintain outdoor center.

Contractor: +\$4k-\$9k • cumulative \$377k-\$483k | **Owner DIY:** +\$1.5k-\$4k • cumulative \$300.5k-\$366k

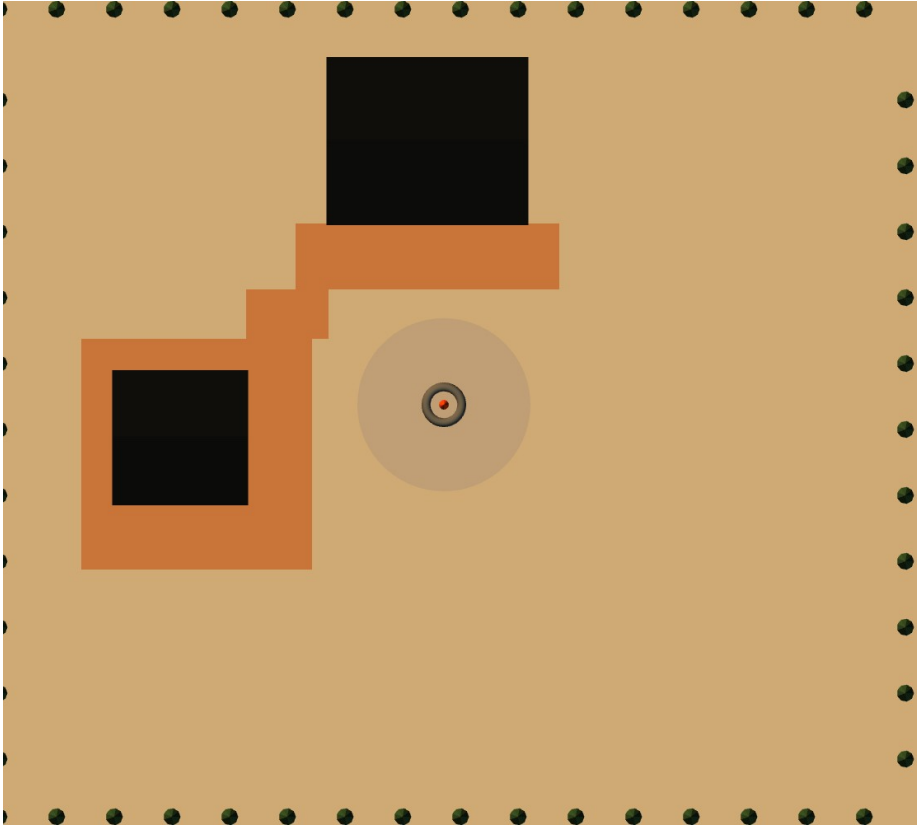


Stage 3: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 4: Bath/sauna house + more deck

Add the 16 x 16 ft bathhouse southwest of the firepit and extend decking from the main house around the bathhouse. The bathhouse is oriented so its east sauna/shower facade faces the courtyard: sauna glazing is on the northern portion and the southern shower portion remains substantially solid; entry is on the opposite/back side.

Contractor: +\$155k-\$225k • cumulative \$532k-\$708k | Owner DIY: +\$82k-\$125k • cumulative \$382.5k-\$491k

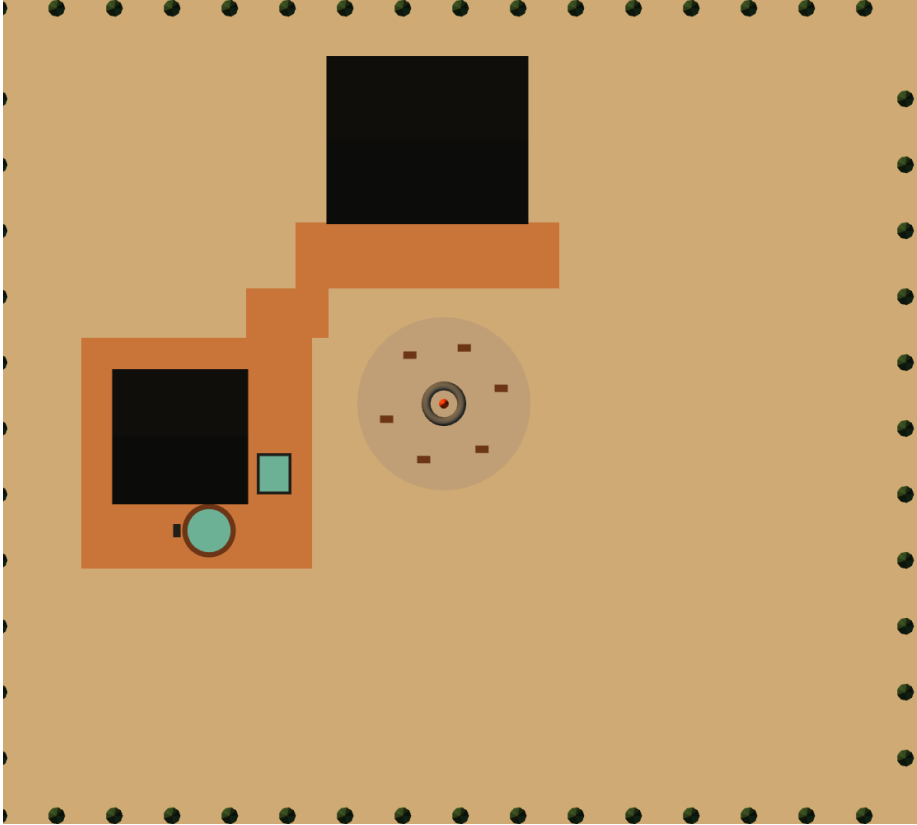


Stage 4: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 5: Courtyard furnishings + hot/cold plunge

Add Adirondack/lounge seating and benches around the firepit. Add the smaller cold plunge immediately east of the bathhouse's shower-side portion. Add the larger wood-fired hot tub south and slightly west of the plunge, on the same enveloping bathhouse deck, without obstructing the sauna glazing.

Contractor: +\$20k-\$40k • cumulative \$552k-\$748k | Owner DIY: +\$13k-\$25k • cumulative \$395.5k-\$516k

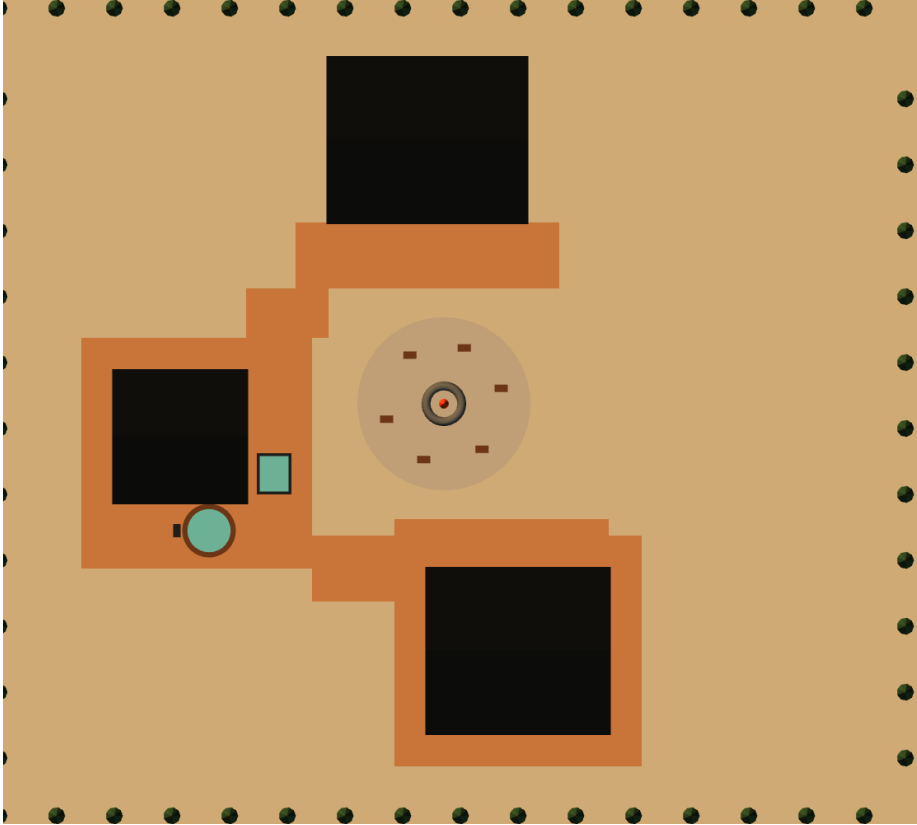


Stage 5: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 6: Full detached ADU + deck connection

Add a complete ~22 x 20 ft / 440 sq. ft. detached ADU, deliberately close in overall scale to the 480 sq. ft. main tiny home. It is a complete dwelling with kitchen, full bath, electricity, heating/cooling, and utilities. Extend the deck network to connect it to the compound.

Contractor: +\$160k-\$250k • **cumulative** \$712k-\$998k | **Owner DIY:** +\$90k-\$150k • **cumulative** \$485.5k-\$666k

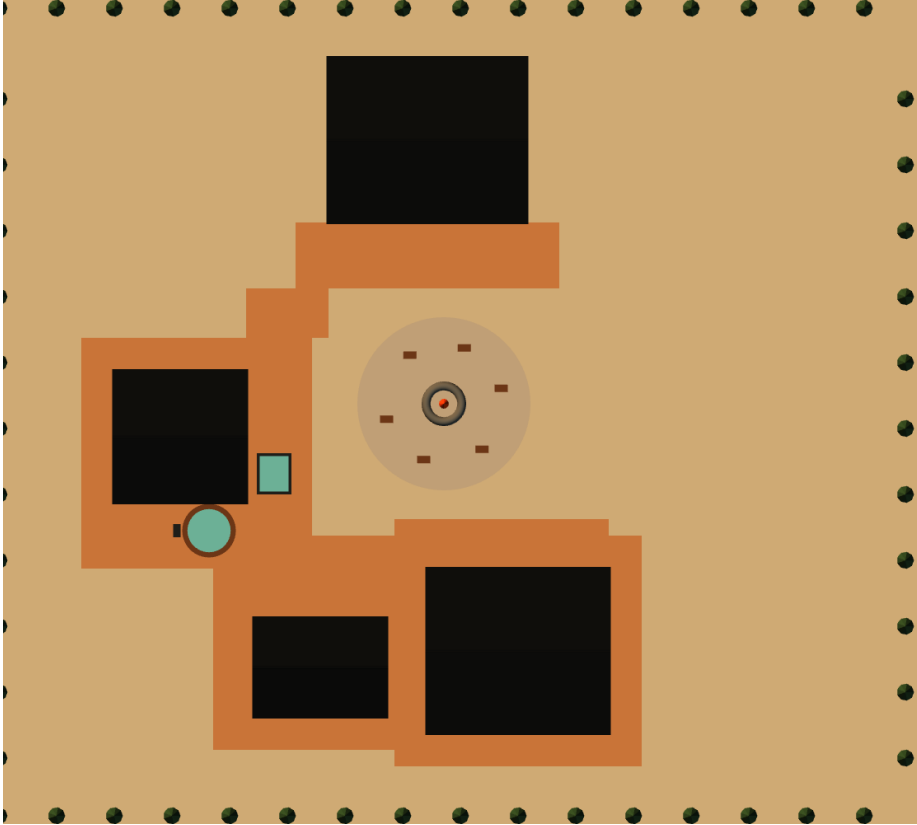


Stage 6: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 7: Guest sleeping cabin + deck connection

Add the smaller guest sleeping cabin west of the ADU. Treat it as a proper permitted sleeping building, not a shed: no kitchen, but a small bathroom, electricity, heating/cooling, appropriate egress glazing, and smoke/CO protection. Extend decking without relocating any prior element.

Contractor: +\$65k-\$115k • **cumulative** \$777k-\$1.113M | **Owner DIY:** +\$35k-\$65k • **cumulative** \$520.5k-\$731k

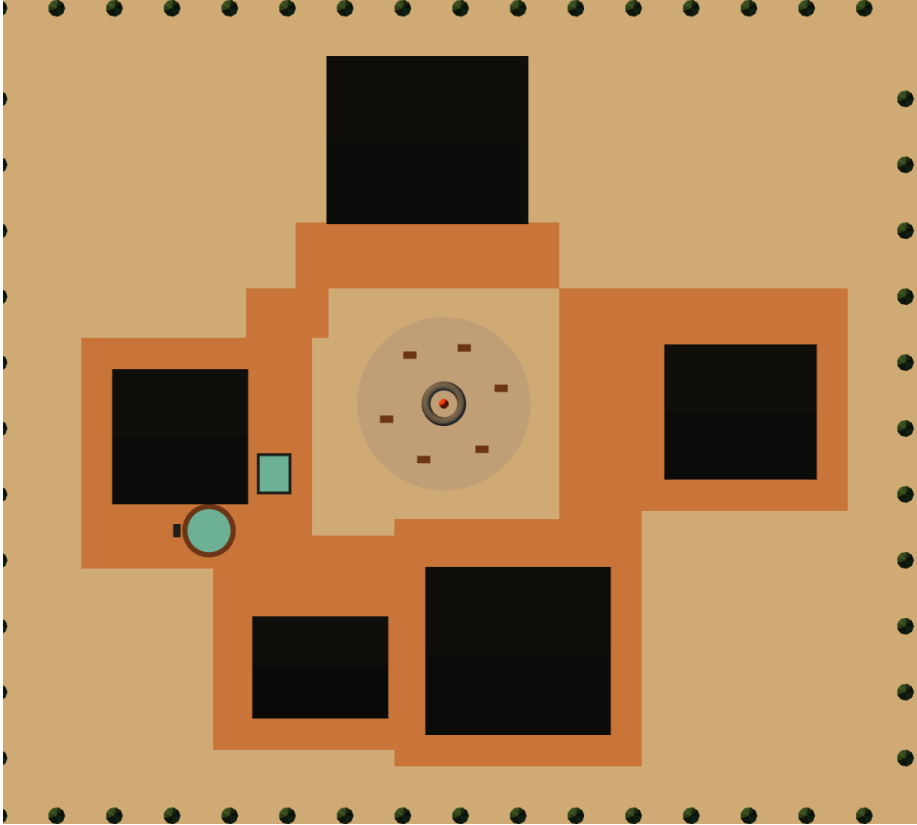


Stage 7: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

7. Stage 8: Covered outdoor kitchen + final deck links

Complete the east side of the courtyard with a covered open-air kitchen/bar pavilion. Include gas grill, smoker, prep counters, bar seating, lighting/outlets, and final deck links. The finished layout preserves all prior building, tub, firepit, and deck positions.

Contractor: +\$45k-\$80k • **cumulative** \$822k-\$1.193M | **Owner DIY:** +\$25k-\$45k • **cumulative** \$545.5k-\$776k



Stage 8: dimension-controlled top-down site plan (left) and photorealistic exterior visualization (right). The right-hand image is grounded in the corresponding staged 3D model; visual material/detail is illustrative while the master site geometry remains fixed across stages.

8. Implementation Strategy and Due Diligence

- Design the final compound before setting the Stage 1 house location. The later stages can be years away, but their coordinates should already be known.
- During Stage 1 trenching, install capped electrical conduit, water sleeves/lines, sanitary provisions, and data/low-voltage conduit toward the future bathhouse, ADU, guest cabin, and outdoor kitchen where feasible.
- Confirm the engineered septic system's approved bedroom/design-flow capacity before purchase. The final use pattern includes the principal home, one full ADU, and one additional guest sleeping room, regardless of how many individual buildings contain plumbing fixtures.
- Confirm potable water/well feasibility. The sample listing reports "Water: See Remarks" and a seasonal stream; do not treat stream water as the permanent residential water solution.
- Seek written pre-application feedback from Hardenburgh on the close compound layout: principal dwelling + detached conditional-use ADU + no-kitchen accessory guest sleeping building + bathhouse + outdoor kitchen/accessory structures.
- Keep the central courtyard close to existing grade. Reserve retaining walls and major cuts/fills for places where actual site conditions make them unavoidable.
- Use a repeatable exterior palette across phases — dark vertical wood siding, black standing-seam roofs, warm wood decks, restrained glazing — so later buildings appear intentional.

Questions to resolve before land purchase

- What exactly is the existing septic system approved to serve, and can it support the final sleeping-room/bedroom load?
- Can the detached ADU be approved in the close compound arrangement through Hardenburgh's conditional-use ADU route rather than being treated as a second principal residence subject to hypothetical-subdivision spacing?
- Will Hardenburgh permit the proposed no-kitchen guest cabin as an accessory sleeping building, including a full bathroom, electricity, and HVAC?
- What specific setbacks, natural-resource constraints, flood/stream buffers, driveway/fire-access requirements, and buildable-area limitations apply to the chosen clearing?
- Where can a code-compliant potable well be located relative to the septic system and final building cluster?
- What service upgrades, if any, are required for the main home + ADU + electric sauna heater + hot-water loads?

9. Sources and Caveats

Ref	Source	URL
S1	Zillow — Tbd Rider Hollow Road, Hardenburgh, NY 12406	https://www.zillow.com/homedetails/Rider-Hollow-Rd-Arkville-NY-12406/32842779_zpid/
S2	User-provided Google Maps pin — 42.102681, -74.523254	https://maps.app.goo.gl/SnPusqYVii4Zu6Ur7
S3	Ulster County — Building an ADU in Ulster County	https://www.ulstercountyny.gov/Departments/Planning/Housing/ADU-Guide
S4	Town of Hardenburgh — Zoning / municipal materials	https://hardenburghny.gov/zoning/

S5	New York Department of State — 19 NYCRR Part 1203 rule text	https://dos.ny.gov/2021-12-10-full-text-rule-part-1203
S6	Town of Hardenburgh — Building Permit Application / instructions	https://hardenburghny.gov/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/Bldg-Application-Hardenburgh2024.pdf

Important caveat

This proposal is a feasibility and visualization document. Actual legality, permitting, site placement, septic capacity, structural design, well location, and construction cost require confirmation by the Town of Hardenburgh, Ulster County/NYC watershed authorities as applicable, licensed design professionals, and local contractors. The top-down plans are dimension-controlled model outputs. The photorealistic views are architectural visualizations grounded in those staged models and should be treated as design intent rather than construction-document-level representations.